

Making a Career Change

Changing paths, with method and courage

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

Making a Career Change

1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Changing paths, with method and courage

Changing job or sector is exciting... and dizzying: fear of getting it wrong, of starting over, others' eyes, financial uncertainty.

This guide helps you understand what pushes and what holds you back, clarify what matters to you, and build your change step by step — without leaping into the void.

Your intention

The career change you're considering (or that's on your mind): _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

What pushes you & what holds you back

A career change often pits the call of new meaning against fear of change, loyalties (family, image), and 'it's too late'.

Untangling the two helps you move for the right reasons.

Example

Torn between wanting to change and fearing he'd 'disappoint', Marc saw his restraint came mostly from family expectations.

Push / pull-back

Write: what pushes me to change · what holds me back (fears, loyalties, image).

Fleeing or moving toward?

Is this change mostly fleeing what you live, or moving toward something? (both is ok)

→ *I tell what pushes me from what holds me — and move clear-eyed.*

The thoughts that block

'It's too late', 'I'm only good at this', 'what if I get it wrong': these all-or-nothing thoughts make change seem impossible.

Softening them reopens what's possible.

Example

Sure that at 40 it was 'over', Nia met people who changed much later. The 'too late' cracked.

Blockers journal

Note: the blocking thought · a fairer version · a real counter-example.

De-dramatize the mistake

Turn 'what if I get it wrong' into 'I can test and adjust along the way'.

→ *Change isn't all-or-nothing — I can test and adjust.*

Clarifying what matters to you

A good change aligns with who you've become: your values, what drives you, the daily life you want. That compass makes the project solid.

You're not after 'another job', but a path that fits you.

Example

By clarifying what truly mattered to her, Léa aimed at a precise field rather than a vague escape.

My compass

Write: my values · what drives me · the working day I want.

The aligned path

Describe in 3 lines a job/sector that would fit this compass.

→ *I seek a path aligned with who I've become.*

Building the project

Concretely: explore (research, meet people, test via immersion or a side project), spot your transferable skills, move step by step, secure your finances, and identify training and funding.

A step-by-step project turns vertigo into a path.

Example

By testing her future field via an evening project before quitting, Sofia validated her choice without risking everything.

My exploration

Note: 2 people in the field to meet · a way to test it · my transferable skills.

My step-by-step plan

Set 3 steps (explore → train/test → switch) + how to secure your finances.

→ *Explore, test, step by step — my change gets built.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Explore before leaping: informational interviews, immersion, a test project.
- Spot your transferable skills (they travel between jobs).
- Move step by step, not all at once.
- Secure a cushion or transition income.
- Research training and its funding.
- Talk to people who made the switch; tell 'fleeing' from 'moving toward'.

To fill in

My exploration

To explore / whom to meet	What I take from it

My transferable skills

Skill	Where it'll serve again

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Untangle what pushes / holds me back.

Week 2 — Soften the thoughts that block.

Week 3 — Clarify my compass (meaning, values).

Week 4 — Build my step-by-step plan.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The job/sector I aim for:
- My first exploration step:
- How I secure my finances:

TO CLOSE

A career change is built — not a leap into the void.

A career change is built — not a leap into the void.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.